Campus France & French Ministry of the Interior

Official Administrative Guide: Validating the VLS-TS Student Visa (ANEF / OFII Procedure)
Long-Stay Visa Valid as a Residence Permit (Visa de Long Séjour valant Titre de Séjour — VLS-TS Étudiant)
Governing Jurisdiction: France (Direction Générale des Étrangers en France / Campus France)

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1. Mandatory Online Validation Deadline (Within 3 Months of Arrival)

If you hold a **VLS-TS student visa** (Visa de Long Séjour valant Titre de Séjour - Étudiant), you are required by French immigration law to validate your visa online within a maximum of **three months (90 days)** following your official entry into France. The validation procedure is 100% digital and must be completed on the official Ministry of the Interior platform: **ANEF (Administration des Étrangers en France)** at administration-etrangers-en-france.interieur.gouv.fr.
Failure to validate within three months results in immediate loss of lawful resident status, revokes your right to work, and prohibits re-entry into the Schengen Area upon departing France.

2. Required Information and Documentation Checklist

Checklist of Required Items for Online ANEF Validation:
• **Valid Email Address:** For receiving communication and the final validation certificate.
• **Passport & Visa Information:** Visa sticker number, visa category (Étudiant), date of issue, and validity dates.
• **Date of Arrival:** The exact date of physical entry into France or the Schengen area (matching the entry stamp).
• **Residential Address in France:** Proof of residence address (student residence hall, rental lease, or host certificate).
• **Payment of Residence Tax (Timbre Fiscal):** A credit or debit card to pay the online residence tax stamp of **50 EUR** (timbre fiscal électronique), or a pre-purchased electronic tax stamp code obtained from a local French tobacco shop (bureau de tabac).

3. Step-by-Step Procedure and Confirmation Certificate

1. Connect to the ANEF website (administration-etrangers-en-france.interieur.gouv.fr) and click on 'Validate your VLS-TS'.
2. Enter your visa number, entry date, and current residential address in France.
3. Pay the 50 EUR fiscal stamp online or input the 16-digit electronic stamp number.
4. Submit your application. Immediately upon validation, the system generates an official PDF confirmation document entitled: **Attestation de validation du VLS-TS**.
5. **Keep this document safe:** You must print and store the Attestation alongside your passport. The Attestation contains your unique 10-digit **Numéro Étranger** (foreign national registration number), which serves as official legal proof of residence in France.

4. Student Rights Granted by a Validated VLS-TS

• **Right to Work (964 Hours per Year):** A validated VLS-TS authorizes international students to work part-time up to **964 hours per year** (equivalent to 60% of the annual statutory working time in France) without requiring a separate provisional work permit (APT).
• **Healthcare Access (Sécurité Sociale):** International students must register for free French public healthcare coverage via the dedicated portal etudiant-etranger.ameli.fr using their Attestation and Numéro Étranger.
• **Housing Subsidies (CAF / APL):** A validated visa allows students to apply for personal housing assistance (Aide Personnalisée au Logement — APL) through the Caisse d'Allocations Familiales (CAF).
• **Schengen Travel:** The validated visa enables unrestricted travel throughout the Schengen Area for up to 90 days per 180-day period.